



OREGON YOUTH AUTHORITY

Policy Statement

Part III – Youth Services (Community)



Subject:

Suicide Prevention in Community Placements

Section – Policy Number:

D: Case Management – 3.4

Supersedes:

III-D-3.4 (04/23)
III-D-3.4 (08/15)
III-D-3.4 (10/10)
III-D-2.2 (10/05)

Effective Date:

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Date of Last

Review/Revision:

None

Related Standards and References:

- [OAR 410-170-0030](#) BRS Program Policies and Procedures
- [OAR 416-530-0060](#) Foster Parent Duties and Responsibilities
- [OYA policy](#): I-E-1.0 Director's Incident Notification and Report
I-E-5.0 Notification to Parents/Guardian
III-A-1.0 Youth Incident Reports - Community
- OYA JJIS document: OYA 4439 OYA Suicide Watch/Precautions
- [Attachment A](#): Community Services Postvention Checklist

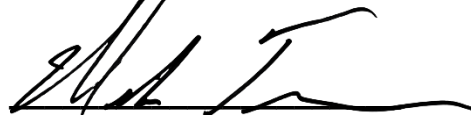
Related Procedures:

- [COM III-D-3.4 \(Youth Death Postvention Plan\)](#)

Policy Owner:

Community Services Assistant
Director

Approved:


Mike Tessean, Director

I. PURPOSE:

This policy establishes guidelines for field staff for the identification, assessment, treatment, and protection of youth under OYA supervision in the community that may be at risk for suicide.

II. POLICY DEFINITIONS:

Nonsuicidal Self-injurious Behavior (NSIB): Intentionally injuring oneself in a manner that often results in damage to body tissue, but without any conscious suicidal intent.

Potentially lethal self-harm behavior: Behavior that intentionally causes physical harm to oneself which, if continued, could result in death.

Substitute care: Residential placements in the community that provide 24-hour-a-day care and/or treatment, excluding a relative's home. Such placements include, but are not limited to, foster care, respite care, proctor care, or contracted residential programs.

Substitute care providers: Persons authorized by OYA through contract or other written agreement to provide supervision and care for youth on parole or probation status in the community.

Suicide risk assessment: A formal evaluation conducted by a mental health practitioner to assess mental health and monitoring requirements of a youth. Suicide assessments often occur after indicators from a suicide screening instrument identify that a youth is at risk.

Suicide attempt: Incomplete, potentially lethal effort to die by suicide.

Suicidal behavior: Suicidal ideation, suicide attempts, and death by suicide.

Suicidal ideation: Having thoughts, ideas, or ruminations about the possibility of ending one's life.

Suicidal Intent: The youth's level of commitment for carrying out their plan or expectation that the plan will result in death. Intent may vary from none to high/full.

Suicidal plan: Identifying a specific method, and possibly a given time frame, in which an individual intends to die by suicide. The presence of a suicidal plan indicates the need to assess for "intent".

III. POLICY:

It is the policy of OYA to provide immediate assistance whenever a youth demonstrates or is reported to be at risk of suicidal behavior.

OYA has identified diversity, equity, and inclusion as an agency priority and initiative, with a goal to build a respectful, diverse, equitable and inclusive environment for youth and staff that is free from harassment, discrimination and bias. Data shows youth of color and LGBTQ+ youth are disproportionately represented in the juvenile justice system. While OYA is only one part of that system, OYA plays a critical role in addressing the historical and systemic inequities it perpetuates. OYA staff must be aware of any biases they have in interpreting a youth's potential for self-harm or suicidal behavior. Staff must act to mitigate these biases to appropriately assess and identify the needs of youth of color and other historically marginalized youth.

This policy establishes procedures for the identification, assessment, treatment, and protection of youth on supervision in the community that may be at risk for suicide.

The contract administrator of any substitute care contract must ensure contracted programs have a suicide prevention policy and written procedures describing how the program will respond when a youth exhibits self-injurious/self-harm or suicidal behavior, and provide training to staff upon initial hire

Foster care certifiers must ensure OYA certified foster care providers follow the relevant guidelines established in OAR 416-530-0060.

IV. GENERAL STANDARDS:

- A. Initial Identification of Suicide and NSIB Risk for Youth in the Community
1. Upon a youth's commitment to OYA, a juvenile parole/probation officer (JPPO) must:
 - a) Review case information and JJIS entries for history of potential suicidal behaviors, suicidal ideation or self-harm behaviors.
 - b) Interview collateral contacts including family members, care providers and other stakeholders concerning the youth's history of potential suicidal behaviors, suicidal ideation or self-harm behaviors.
 - c) Administer the agency approved community suicide risk assessment tool to the youth, and upload the completed assessment into JJIS imported documents.
 - (1) The agency's approved triage protocol must be followed based on the youth's responses.
 - (2) The JPPO must complete immediate safety actions, including but not limited to, calling 988, arranging a mental health assessment including a suicide risk assessment, or taking the youth to the hospital if the screening indicates elevated or imminent risk.
 - d) Record separately each documented and reported incident of potential suicidal behavior, suicidal ideation or self-harm behavior in JJIS Population Group "OYA *Suicide Documentation" in the "Suicidal Behavior" subcategory. This documentation provides a historical tracking of potential suicidal and self-harm behaviors that can be easily accessed.
 2. The JPPO must notify substitute care providers during the referral process when a youth has a history of suicidal or NSIB behavior. Such notification must be documented in JJIS notes.
- B. Intervention Procedures
1. Any OYA staff member who is concerned about a youth's safety or wellbeing must consult with the youth's field supervisor or designee to assess the most appropriate level of intervention to ensure the safety and wellbeing of the youth.

If further consultation is deemed necessary, the staff member is encouraged to:

- a) Consult with the youth's community-based treatment providers, as applicable;
 - b) Consult with the OYA behavioral health services coordinator; and
 - c) Consult with the OYA supervising clinical psychologist.
2. Any OYA staff member who becomes aware of a youth communicating or demonstrating potentially lethal self-harm behavior or suicidal behavior, must immediately respond in a manner that protects youth safety and wellbeing.

Staff must:

- a) Immediately access local emergency mental health crisis services for assessment;
 - b) Immediately notify the field supervisor;
 - c) Document the incident in a Youth Incident Report (YIR); and
 - d) Document all notifications in the YIR (e.g., to the family; Director's Office).
3. Upon becoming aware of the incident, the youth's JPPO must:
- a) Immediately request documentation from the provider who completed a suicide risk assessment following the incident; and
 - b) Immediately forward any documentation received from the provider to the OYA behavioral health services coordinator for incident classification determination.
4. Field supervisors who are notified of a youth **demonstrating** potentially lethal self-harm behavior or suicidal behavior must immediately notify the Community Services assistant director or designee.
5. Field supervisors who are notified of a youth **communicating or demonstrating** potentially lethal self-harm behavior or suicidal behavior must:
- a) Determine notification of parents/guardians based on OYA policy I-E-5.0 (Notification to Parents/Guardians); and
 - b) Determine notification of others (e.g., juvenile department, substitute care program, extended family); and

- c) Ensure notifications are made as soon as possible, and no later than 24 hours after becoming aware of the incident.

C. Documenting Suicidal and Nonsuicidal Self-Injurious Behavior

- 1. All instances of known past and present suicidal behavior and NSIBs exhibited by a youth in OYA custody must be documented in the JJIS Population Group “OYA *Suicide Documentation” in the “Suicidal Behavior” subcategory.

- a) Documented or self-reported suicidal behavior and NSIBs exhibited **prior** to a youth’s OYA custody must be entered in the JJIS Population Group “OYA *Suicide Documentation” by the JPPO within 30 days of commitment to OYA.

- (1) Each prior incident must be entered as a unique subcategory, using the dates of the incident as the subcategory start date.

JJIS will automatically create a “Suicide Risk” Alert when the Population Group is entered.

- (2) **Chronic NSIB**
Chronic nonlethal self-harm behaviors may be summarized in a single Population Group entry. In the Population Group “Notes” field, specify date ranges, types of self-harm behaviors demonstrated, implements used, and treatment interventions provided.

- (3) These JJIS entries must only be closed at case closure.

- b) Documenting Suicidal Behavior and NSIBs **during** OYA Custody

- (1) The JPPO must document youth incidents of suicide behavior and NSIBs exhibited **while** in OYA custody in accordance with OYA policy III-A-1.0 Youth Incident Reports - Field.

- (2) Automatic JJIS documentation

Once the OYA behavioral health services coordinator has entered the incident classification and the YIR is locked, JJIS will automatically create a Population Group entry of “OYA *Suicide Documentation” and a “Suicide Risk” Alert.

- (3) These JJIS entries must only be closed at case closure.

2. The field supervisor or designee is responsible for ensuring all instances of known past and present suicidal behavior and NSIBs exhibited by a youth in the community are documented in JJIS in a timely manner. This documentation supports safe and effective case supervision and planning.

D. Youth Movements

1. Community to secure placement

The JPPO must notify detention or youth correctional facility staff of a youth's history of suicidal or NSIB behavior when the youth is placed in detention or a youth correctional facility. The notification must be documented in JJIS notes.

2. Community placements/transitions

- a) Prior to a youth's transition in a community placement or from a secure placement into the community, the JPPO must review the youth's current suicide risk level and any current precautions on OYA form YA 4439 Enhanced Supervision Precautions(for youth in close custody).
- b) If a youth has an elevated suicide risk level or precaution, the JPPO must notify the behavioral health services coordinator to assist in the development of a support or safety plan. The support or safety plan must be implemented prior to the youth transitioning to a less restrictive environment, unless the youth is transitioning to a psychiatric residential program. Plans must be documented in JJIS notes.

E. Training

All OYA field staff must participate in pre-service training and biennial updates that at a minimum include differentiation between suicidal behavior and NSIBs, the warning signs of suicide, intervention techniques, and emergency protocols.

V. OYA GENERAL FIELD PROCEDURE REQUIRED: YES

The OYA general field procedure provides specific guidelines for the following topic areas:

- A. Initial response notification;
- B. Use of the Postvention Planning Checklist; and
- C. Communication with key partners, staff and families.

VI. LOCAL OPERATING PROTOCOL REQUIRED: NO

Community Services Youth Death Postvention Checklist	
Date:	Local Suicide Postvention Response Lead:
Youth Name:	JJIS#:
Date of Death:	Youth Location:
Field Supervisor:	Assigned JPPO:

First 24 hours		
Task	Staff assigned	Completed
Notify Supervisor and Chief of Parole and Probation		☐
Notify Community Services AD and Communications Director		☐
Notify Local County Postvention Response Lead ; if youth suicide. (OHA is available to assist if local PRL is unavailable or needs additional resources.)		☐
Notify Parent/Guardian, if not already notified, partner with law enforcement resources for notification. If parents/guardians already notified, have in person visit with family as soon as possible.		☐
Notify peer support coordinator and determine level of contact requested by JPPO. Reminder: Discuss need and start Critical Incident Stress Management debrief within 1-2 days.	Chief of Parole/Probation	☐
Notify local office team members and discuss with Chief how/when to notify rest of OYA field.		☐
Send email to facility, community resources, foster care, and OIIR to request notices be made to past units/programs: - Last 12 months, immediate notice 12+ months ago, notice in 1-2 weeks		☐
Determine and notify immediate family members, or other support people involved with youth. Identify any language access needs and work with OIIR to set up.		☐
Confirm with local PRL that school or other community programs youth was attending have been notified		☐
Notify ODHS, if there is an open case		☐
Update youth deceased indicator button and date on JJIS Youth Info page		☐
Reassign case to other JPPO or Field Supervisor		☐
Complete YIR/DIR in JJIS		☐

First 24 -72 hours		
Task	Staff assigned	Completed
Notify defense attorney, ODDS worker, county worker, other prior workers or treatment providers		☐
Notify OYA Tribal Liaison, if youth is enrolled tribal member		☐
Determine best way to support local office or other impacted units (i.e. Foster Care, CRU, contracted provider)		☐
Follow up with family on how OYA can support costs for burial/service or other related needs, and confirm family has information on the Youth Suicide Loss Support Fund ; Determine other needs of family and provide connections to local resources (e.g. food train, GoFundMe, etc.) Be aware and respectful of cultural norms around death and bereavement.		☐

First Week		
Task	Staff assigned	Completed
Revisit what type of contact and support the JPPO wants.		☐
Follow-up with family on needs and offer support to coordinate funeral/memorial		☐
Identify youth at-risk and plan for additional follow-up		☐
Notify JPPO of youth who were impacted to have additional check-ins.		☐
Connect with local PRL as needed to update on identified needs and resources.		☐

First Month		
Task	Staff assigned	Completed
Continue to check-in with staff	Peer support team	☐
Notify JPPO of youth who were impacted to have additional check-ins.		☐
Help coordinate OYA youth attendance at a funeral or memorial, if appropriate		☐

First Month and beyond		
Task	Staff assigned	Completed
Request termination of case and close JJIS notebook, after CIR is completed		☐
Notify peer support team if litigation is filed and determine plan to notify and support the staff		☐

Attachment A: Community Services Postvention Checklist

Continue to check-in with staff	Peer support team	☐
Consider whether suicide prevention training is scheduled for the impacted office in the four months after a suicide		☐
Debrief of the OYA Postvention Response Team		☐
Determine Critical Incident Review Team members		☐
At the one-year anniversary of the death, determine if staff need additional support		☐